

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior Software Developer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Seasoned Python Backend Engineer and Team Lead with over 9 years of experience in architecting, developing, and scaling backend services, particularly for fast-paced B2B and SaaS ecosystems. Proven track record of delivering asynchronous, microservice-based solutions using FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker, and Kubernetes in production. Experienced in leading cross-functional teams, mentoring developers, conducting code reviews, and establishing CI/CD pipelines. Passionate about building resilient, scalable systems aligned with business goals in cloud-native environments (AWS, GCP).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL
- **Frameworks & Tools:** FastAPI, Flask, Django, Pydantic, Strawberry, Celery
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, Clickhouse (basic), ScyllaDB (basic)
- **Messaging & Async:** Asyncio, RabbitMQ, NATS
- **ORM:** SQLAlchemy
- **DevOps & Infra:** Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, GitLab CI/CD, AWS (ECS, RDS, S3), GCP
- **Monitoring & Testing:** Prometheus, Grafana, pytest, unittest, Sentry
- **Version Control & Collaboration:** Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Jira
- **Other:** REST APIs, microservices, scalability, software architecture, team mentoring

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sensidev

Senior Software Engineer

September 2021 – December 2024

Timișoara, Romania

- Led a cross-functional backend team to design, implement, and scale microservices using FastAPI, Docker, and PostgreSQL across multiple B2B client integrations.
- Oversaw technical architecture and transition to Kubernetes-based deployment on AWS, ensuring HA and scalability for client-facing APIs under high-load conditions.
- Designed async workflows using Celery and RabbitMQ, achieving performance gains and reducing latency in data-intensive transaction pipelines.
- Mentored junior engineers through code reviews, pair programming, and monthly knowledge sharing sessions to ensure knowledge retention and promote best practices.
- Built CI/CD pipelines using GitLab CI to support Dockerized FastAPI deployments with testing, linting, and multi-stage builds.
- Drove transition from monolith to microservices by identifying system boundaries, leading refactoring efforts, and handling inter-service contracts and schema evolution.

- Integrated observability stack (Prometheus + Grafana) to monitor performance, throughput, and uptime, reducing downtime incidents by 40% over 1 year.
- Acted as technical liaison with product managers to align engineering sprints with business objectives, ensuring timely and relevant delivery across verticals.

Syscom Digital

Software Engineer

October 2019 – August 2021

Bucharest, Romania

- Developed backend APIs using Flask and SQLAlchemy for digital marketing analytics tools interfacing with high-throughput event pipelines.
- Maintained and refactored PostgreSQL and MySQL database schemas, enforcing indexing strategies that improved query performance by over 30%.
- Worked with Docker to containerize internal services, streamlining onboarding, testing, and production deployment for cloud-based infrastructure.
- Implemented Redis-based caching and session management to enhance platform responsiveness and reduce DB load in peak usage periods.
- Conducted structured code reviews and introduced Git Flow branching strategies to enforce quality and deployment discipline within the dev team.
- Collaborated with frontend developers to define RESTful API contracts, ensuring seamless communication and validation using Pydantic models.
- Piloted transition of legacy synchronous code to async using asyncio and aiohttp, resulting in better concurrency and throughput.
- Participated in agile ceremonies including backlog grooming and sprint planning, enabling better velocity tracking and delivery estimation.

Soft Build

Software Developer

June 2016 – July 2019

Timișoara, Romania

- Delivered scalable RESTful APIs and backend logic for ERP and eCommerce integrations using Django and PostgreSQL for EU-based retail clients.
- Designed robust CI/CD workflows with Jenkins to automate deployments and regression testing across staging and production environments.
- Deployed Dockerized services on bare-metal Linux servers, gradually migrating legacy infrastructure toward container-first architecture.
- Integrated Celery for background tasks (report generation, file processing), enabling seamless handling of long-running user operations.
- Created documentation and onboarding guides, improving new hire ramp-up time by 50% and reducing onboarding-related queries.
- Developed custom dashboards using React for internal tools, coordinating closely with UI/UX designers to implement backend support.
- Initiated weekly brown-bag sessions to promote Python best practices, async programming models, and container orchestration strategies.
- Introduced automated testing frameworks using pytest and coverage metrics, resulting in higher reliability and faster bug resolution.

Decima Digital

Software Developer

November 2015 – April 2016

Tallinn, Estonia

- Built REST endpoints in Flask and integrated 3rd-party APIs for financial analytics platform servicing fintech clients in Northern Europe.
- Implemented PostgreSQL queries and stored procedures optimized for large-scale financial reports and high-frequency data reads.
- Introduced task queue system with Celery and RabbitMQ for asynchronous report generation, increasing parallelization capacity by 4x.
- Assisted with server deployment and database migration scripts during cloud migration project.
- Supported bug fixing and enhancements for production environments by maintaining system logs and error tracebacks.
- Wrote testable, modular Python code and maintained consistent API contracts documented with Swagger/OpenAPI.
- Collaborated with frontend developers to enable end-to-end integration flows.
- Applied Agile methodologies, actively participating in sprint demos and retrospectives to improve process and planning.

Borna Technology

Software Developer Intern

September 2014 – August 2015

Tallinn, Estonia

- Assisted in developing internal Python tools to automate QA regression testing for mobile applications on Android/iOS platforms.
- Wrote Selenium-based test suites and bash automation scripts for scheduled integration testing on CI servers.
- Contributed to frontend bug fixes and backend patch releases on Flask-based internal admin panel.
- Documented REST API endpoints and designed postman collections for QA team usage.
- Participated in weekly code reviews and took initiative to identify and fix flaky tests in staging.
- Wrote detailed user manuals and tech notes for non-technical users.
- Implemented data validation scripts in Python to ensure test environments matched production schemas.
- Supported senior engineers in database migrations, Git operations, and JIRA issue tracking.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,

2010 – 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- ❖ AWS Certified Developer – Associate (2023)
- ❖ Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) (2022)
- ❖ Python for Data Engineering – Coursera (2021)

PROJECTS

- ✓ **Modular Game Aggregator Backend**
Architected and developed a pluggable backend system using FastAPI and Strawberry for a gaming

platform aggregator, allowing integration of 20+ providers with unified schema mapping and minimal downtime.

✓ **iGaming CI/CD Pipeline Infrastructure**

Designed a secure and scalable GitLab CI/CD architecture for containerized services using Kubernetes and Helm, including secrets management, blue/green deployments, and smoke testing.

✓ **High-Throughput Event Pipeline with RabbitMQ & Celery**

Led the refactoring of existing synchronous architecture into an async microservice stack using RabbitMQ, Celery, and Redis, reducing event processing time by 65%.

✓ **Metrics & Monitoring Platform Integration**

Integrated Grafana dashboards and Prometheus exporters across backend services, offering real-time visibility into service health and latency, aligned with SLO targets.